



Sir Knights, Friends, Family, Honored Guests,

Now is the day! Now is the hour! Now is the age! Now, more than ever, the world needs Freemasonry! Society is crying out for the humble and compassionate Soldier of the Cross.

We may never know the Father's reason; nor His plan; but, rest assured, you and I are a part of His divine plan. You may be dismayed and discouraged, but the purpose is clear.

We read in Psalms 118:22 "The stone the builders rejected, has become the cornerstone." Not knowing the purpose of that stone, they rejected it. They cast it out in ignorance. Not knowing G-d's Plan they threw it aside.

A true craftsman would have employed his faith in the Architect. As builders of our moral and spiritual edifice, how often did we feel unemployed, cast out, thrown aside; useless to the designs our limited eyes could see? I tell truly, each of you were formed by the ultimate builder, that divine Creator of all that is seen and unseen. Only the Father knows when He will employ us, and how we fit into His design.

It is not for us to judge or discern. The Holy Scriptures are filled with the historical accounts of imperfect people being selected in G-d's time, to be employed to complete the design G-d needed. Noah was a drunk and yet G-d called him. Abraham was too old and yet G-d called him. Isaac was a daydreamer, and Jacob lied. Joseph was abused. Isaiah preached naked. Jonah ran from God. Peter denied Christ three times and yet G-d called him. The Disciples fell asleep while Jesus was praying. Mary Magdalene was possessed

and abandoned and yet G-d called her. The Samaritan woman was married and divorced five times over. Paul was a murderer and yet G-d called him.

Like each of us, none of them were perfect; and like each of us, they would not know in their weakest moments that the Father had a plan for them, and that they could become the catalyst for a greater good. Only the Father knows. As a just and loving Father; G-d knows the potential He placed within each of us.

In 1 Corinthians 4: 4-5, Saint Paul writes:

“ 4.)- For I know nothing by myself; yet am I not hereby justified: but he that judgeth me is the Lord. 5.)- Therefore judge nothing before the time, until the Lord come, who both will bring to light the hidden things of darkness, and will make manifest the counsels of the hearts: and then shall every man have praise of God.”

Paul reminds us that, though we are imperfect, through faith, we perfectly fit the Father's use.

Christ Jesus, the Redeemer of man, was the rejected stone, in the time of His Ministry and amongst the Community he lived. Yet, society has and always will need Christ. We read in Acts 4: 8 -12 -

8.)- Then Peter, filled with the Holy Ghost, said unto them, Ye rulers of the people, and elders of Israel, 9.)- if we this day be examined of the good deed done to the impotent man, by what means he is made whole; 10.)- be it known unto you all, and to all the people of Israel, that by the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, whom ye crucified, whom God raised from the dead, even by him doth this man stand here before you whole.

11.)- This is the stone which was set at nought of you builders, which is become the head of the corner. 12.)- Neither is there salvation in any other: for there is none other name under heaven given among men, whereby we must be saved.

Society walked with Christ, and some still rejected the Corner Stone. Here we also see Saint Peter refer to Christ as the Head of the Corner – which is to say that the Head of the Corner is the Keystone. The Keystone is the stone that is the most elevated in the structure of an Arch; the one stone, that once set at the center, offers structure and strengthens all other stones; uniting the whole, to fulfill the same purpose. I find it fitting that Simon Peter, whom Christ called Cephas (a word in Aramaic that means Rock), would describe Christ as the keystone.

Like the Keystone, if we place Christ at the head of our structure, and in the center of our life; through Him we gain strength, harmony, and peace.

Society has been focused on loud expectations borne from chaos. In the noise, clutter, and confusion of it all - they have blinded themselves to light; and deafened their

ears to that still small voice. As Elijah would learn in 1 Kings 19: 11-12 you will not find G-d in noise, clutter, and confusion - For it was written:

11.)- And he said, Go forth, and stand upon the mount before the Lord. And, behold, the Lord passed by, and a great and strong wind rent the mountains, and brake in pieces the rocks before the Lord; but the Lord was not in the wind: and after the wind an earthquake; but the Lord was not in the earthquake: 12.)- and after the earthquake a fire; but the Lord was not in the fire: and after the fire a still small voice.

Likewise, Christ was not found in the noise, clutter, and confusion. Christ was arrested, convicted, scourged (that is to say taunted, beaten, and tortured); He was crucified, died, and had a spear thrust into His side. He was buried and entombed; and as we learn in the Glorious Mysteries of Easter – Christ was not found in His Passion. His suffering is a testament to His Love of the Father, His Love of humanity, and His obedience and faith in the Father's plan. Christ paid the debts of mankind's trespasses. He died for the sins of humanity – but Christ is Risen!

In the Holy Gospel according to Saint Matthew 28: 5-6: “ And the angel answered and said unto the women, Fear not ye: for I know that ye seek Jesus, which was crucified. He is not here: for he is risen, as he said.”

As we learned in the Holy Gospel according to Saint John, Christ appeared to Mary – but she did not recognize Jesus. So consumed by the Passion Christ endured, and the pain of her own suffering; her eyes were blind and her ears deafened. It was not until Christ called her that she heard that still small voice, and recognized our Lord and Savior.

Let us, as Soldiers of the Cross, and servants of the Risen Christ open ourselves completely: heart, mind, body, spirit, and soul. Let us clear away the clutter, silence the noise, and abandon the confusion of society. As we kneel at the Cross in humble gratitude of the Passion our Lord endured, let us not focus on the pain or sorrows of life; but rather let us pick up the Cross and be consumed with the Love Christ filled His heart with; that Love which enabled Him to become the Lamb of G-d.

Our first duty as Christian Knights should be to embrace Christ Jesus as our living keystone; placing Him at the height and center of our daily life, remembering the compassion and forgiveness of Christ's heart.

Yes, even a sinner like me, can be worthy of Christ's benevolence, as Christ asks, “Where are your accusers?” Each of us, are worthy of that new life in Christ; each of us, can hear those charitable words of “then neither do I condemn you.” And In justice, Christ sets us back to labor when He instructs us to “Get up and sin no more.” (John 8: 10-11)

Christ even gave us the roadmap to success. When confronted, Jesus said: “Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind.

This is the first and great commandment. And the second is like unto it, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself. On these two commandments hang all the law and the prophets.”

These were not just polite suggestions, but Commandments in which to increase our strength, harmony, and peace. By this, we will know our purpose in faith, hope, and charity – which is to say that compassionate, forgiving love - rooted in fortitude, temperance, prudence, and above all, justice.

Justice without Love is vengeance. Likewise, Love without Justice is tyranny. Neither has a place in the heart of a Christian Knight. We must employ the virtues Christ has taught us. First at home, and then to the society of friends and neighbors for which we are blessed to live amongst.

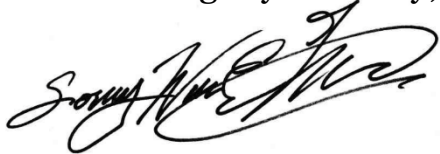
This is the calling of every Christian Knight and the purpose of every Freemason. In the Glorious Mystery of Easter, Christ has conquered death. As Christ is the truth, the way, and the life – we have become His disciples.

We may never know the Father’s plan; but we know G-d has created us to meet His purpose and in His time. We know that we are called to become humble servants of the Risen Christ. We know that our hearts desire to follow Christ. More than this, we know that Christ is the light that will lift the darkest veils from the eyes of our neighbors; and that Christ is that still small voice that can help deafened ears to hear. We believe that we are the servants meant to help our neighbors to find that love, harmony, and peace found in the Christ we follow.

To follow Christ, we must emulate the example He gave to the world – and become living examples that, in living according to His Truth, His way, and His life – is at once the pathway to happiness and life everlasting; as well as becoming that stone that is fitted for the Father’s use in His plan.

The time is now. We must celebrate the Glorious Mystery by living according to that keystone – which is a Christ-centered life. Here, happiness is borne through Christ Jesus. Amen.

Yours in Knightly Courtesy,



Sir Knight William E. McCraw, EC
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